Nash B. Maulana

Nash B. Maulana (born in Datu Piang, Cotabato, now Maguindanao del Sur) is a Filipino journalist, author, inventor, and public information director from the Bangsamoro region of Mindanao.

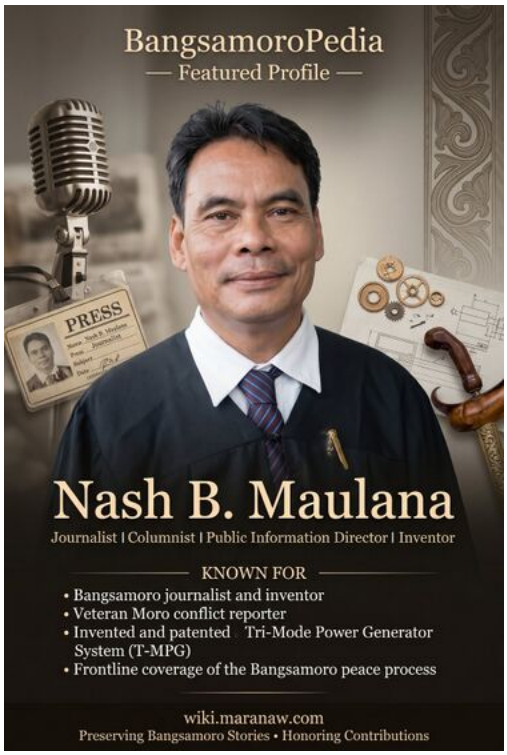
He is widely recognized for his decades of frontline reporting on the Moro conflict and the southern Philippine peace process, work that often placed him in direct physical danger.

Outside the newsroom, Maulana pursued a second life in engineering, eventually patenting the **Tri-Mode Power Generator System (T-MPG)**, a renewable energy utility model designed to bring electricity to off-grid, conflict-affected schools in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM).

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Nash B. Maulana



Personal Information

Born: Datu Piang, Cotabato (now Maguindanao del Sur), Philippines

Nationality

Filipino

Education

BS Electrical Engineering (partial), National University, Manila
BA Journalism and Communications, Polytechnic University of the Philippines, Manila

Occupation(s)

EARLY LIFE AND EDUCATION

Nash B. Maulana was born in Datu Piang, a municipality in the province of Cotabato, now administratively part of Maguindanao del Sur in the BARMM.

He completed his elementary education at the **Datu Gumbay Piang Central Elementary School** in his hometown, then pursued high school at **Notre Dame of Dulawan**, also located in Datu Piang.

For college, Maulana moved to Manila, where he enrolled in **BS Electrical Engineering at National University**.

Though he did not finish the engineering degree, his exposure to electronics and technical problem-solving would prove formative years later, when he returned to engineering not as a student but as a self-taught inventor.

He eventually completed a **Bachelor of Arts in Journalism and Communications at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines** in Manila, the credential that would anchor his long career in media.

While studying, he worked as a student employee at the **BSP Kiosk in Luneta Park, Manila** (1983), balancing the demands of work and academics in the country's capital.

Journalist, Columnist, Public Information Director, Inventor

Region

Bangsamoro, Mindanao, Philippines

Patent

Tri-Mode Power Generator System (T-MPG), IPOPHL Utility Model

Notability

Bangsamoro journalist and inventor; veteran Moro conflict reporter who patented a renewable energy system to power rural schools in post-conflict Mindanao

Known For

Frontline coverage of the Bangsamoro peace process; patenting the Tri-Mode Power Generator System (T-MPG); Project Energizing Schools initiative

CAREER IN JOURNALISM AND PUBLIC SERVICE

Early Employment and Public Information Work

After finishing his studies, Maulana began his career in public service before formally entering national media.

He served as an **Office Clerk** and later as an **Information Officer** at the **Office of Muslim Affairs and Cultural Communities (OMACC)** from 1984 to 1985 and again from 1987 to 1989.

These positions gave him early exposure to the intersection of government communication and Muslim community affairs, experience that would inform his later journalism and his years as a public information director.

National Media Career

Maulana entered mainstream journalism in the late 1980s, joining the **Philippine Daily Globe** as a news correspondent from 1988 to 1992.

From 1989 onward, he took on a column at **The Mindanao Cross**, a byline he has maintained to the present day, making it one of the longest continuous writing engagements in his career.

In 1992, he joined the **Philippine Daily Inquirer** as a news correspondent, covering the Bangsamoro beat out of Cotabato City.

He held that post until 2017, a run of twenty-five years that positioned him as one of the most experienced reporters on southern Philippine affairs in the country.

He also contributed to the **Philippine Free Press** in 2007, lending his perspective on Mindanao to one of the Philippines' oldest English-language publications.

Reporting the Bangsamoro Peace Process

For over three decades, Maulana's primary beat was the Moro conflict and its many iterations: ceasefire negotiations, ancestral domain disputes, civilian displacement, and the slow, uneven construction of autonomous governance in Muslim Mindanao.

He chronicled the evolution of the peace tracks from the early autonomous experiments under the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) through to the formal establishment of the BARMM under the Bangsamoro Organic Law.

In 2014, his reporting on the **Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB)** drew particular attention, especially his coverage of the weapons decommissioning process involving the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF).

Maulana's reporting highlighted what many observers considered the most difficult element of the peace deal: the disarmament of MILF fighters, who held deep cultural and security attachments to their firearms.

He documented the creation of the **Independent Decommissioning Body (IDB)**, the multilateral mechanism tasked with overseeing the phased disarmament and normalization of former combatants, and his accounts helped audiences outside Mindanao understand why this phase of peace-building required particular patience and trust-building.

The 1996 Ambush

The risks of covering Mindanao's conflict zones were not abstract for Maulana.

On **March 20, 1996**, he and fellow journalist **Ali Macabalang** were ambushed by a gunman in Cotabato City.

Macabalang sustained a wound to the neck.

Maulana was shot twice in the leg.

He survived the attack and, after recovering, returned directly to his beat, an act that drew wide respect from colleagues and deepened his standing as one of the region's most committed press figures.

Government Service: ARMM Bureau of Public Information

In addition to his journalism, Maulana served as **Director III** of the **ARMM Bureau of Public Information** from 2010 to 2013.

In that role, he helped shape the communication strategy of the autonomous regional government during a critical period in the Bangsamoro peace track, translating policy decisions and peace initiatives into language accessible to the region's diverse communities.

THE TRI-MODE POWER GENERATOR SYSTEM (T-MPG)

From Reporter to Inventor

Alongside decades of reporting, Maulana pursued a parallel interest in electronics and engineering, one that traced back to his unfinished engineering degree in Manila.

The problem he set out to solve was not abstract: rural schools across the BARMM remained cut off from the national power grid, limiting children's access to computers, lights, and basic learning tools.

In communities that had already lost years of education to armed conflict, the absence of reliable electricity compounded an already severe disadvantage.

Maulana's response was practical.

He spent years designing and refining a generator system that could operate independently of grid infrastructure, using a self-charging battery mechanism that could sustain output in remote, conflict-affected areas.

The Patent

The result was the **Tri-Mode Power Generator System (T-MPG)**, officially recognized by the **Intellectual Property Office of the Philippines (IPOPHL)** as a patented **Utility Model**.

The T-MPG is a self-charging, battery-driven generator prototype that draws its distinctiveness from its operational design: rather than relying on a single energy source, the system routes power conversion through three separate operational paths.

This multi-channel architecture allows the generator to maintain stable electrical output even in areas entirely off-grid, making it particularly suited to the geography and infrastructure gaps of rural Bangsamoro communities.

The patent made Maulana something of a regional celebrity in technology circles, celebrated as a veteran political reporter who had successfully crossed into green energy engineering.

PROJECT ENERGIZING SCHOOLS

Maulana did not develop the T-MPG as a commercial product.

His goal, from the beginning, was deployment: getting working units into underfunded classrooms across the BARMM.

To that end, he launched **Project Energizing Schools**, an initiative structured around two interlocking goals.

The first is direct electrification: providing rural schools with immediate, reliable power so that students and teachers can use computers, lighting, and modern educational materials.

The second is skills transfer: introducing the mechanics of the T-MPG to local youth and former combatants classified as peace beneficiaries.

By teaching community members how to build and maintain the generators themselves, Maulana embeds a practical science and technology curriculum into communities that have had limited access to vocational training, and that have often known only conflict as the backdrop to their daily lives.

LEGACY AND SIGNIFICANCE

Nash B. Maulana represents an unusual figure in Philippine journalism: a frontline correspondent who did not stop at documenting a region's problems, but who used his own hands, and his own patent, to address one of them.

His career spans the full arc of the Bangsamoro peace process, from the early ceasefire negotiations of the 1990s through the ratification of the Bangsamoro Organic Law and the formal creation of the BARMM.

He survived an assassination attempt that might have ended another journalist's career, and returned to reporting.

He earned a national patent in a technical field entirely outside his primary profession.

And he built a community program that ties renewable energy infrastructure directly to the education of a generation growing up in post-conflict Mindanao.

In that sense, Maulana's legacy is not simply that of a chronicler of Bangsamoro history.

He became, in the most literal sense, part of it.

SELECTED WORKS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

- Coverage of the Bangsamoro peace process, **Philippine Daily Inquirer** (1992 to 2017)
- Column, **The Mindanao Cross** (1989 to present)
- Contributor, **Philippine Free Press** (2007)
- 2014 report on MILF weapons decommissioning and the Comprehensive Agreement on the Bangsamoro (CAB), published in the Inquirer
- Patented Utility Model: Tri-Mode Power Generator System (T-MPG), IPOPHL
- Project Energizing Schools, BARMM

EXTERNAL LINKS

- Online profile of Nash B. Maulana (https://tinyurl.com/5y6zmz97)
- Philippine Daily Inquirer (https://www.inquirer.net)
- BangsamoroPedia (https://wiki.maranaw.com)

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